

GUIDELINES ON THE STRENGTHENED WORK IMMERSION, FIELD EXPOSURE, AND ARTS APPRENTICESHIP

Policy Briefer

A. Nature of off-campus experiential learning

Work Immersion, Field Exposure (Off-campus), and Arts Apprenticeship are integral components of the Strengthened Senior High School curriculum, which ensures all learners receive safe, meaningful, and industry-responsive experiences.

Work Immersion refers to a structured learning component that provides learners with hands-on experience in a real workplace setting. It is designed to develop practical skills, work ethics, communication skills, and to be ready for employment under the TechPro Track and Academic Track. Work Immersion is mandatory for all TechPro learners and remains optional for all Academic Track learners.

Field Exposure refers to an experiential learning elective for the Academic Track, designed to provide learners with structured opportunities to observe professional environments aligned with their chosen path. It aims to strengthen career awareness, instill professional work ethics and deeper appreciation of the competencies in the world of work. There is Field Exposure (Off-Campus) which is 80 hours and Field Exposure (In-Campus) which is 160 hours.

Arts Apprenticeship provides learners with intensive, hands-on training in visual arts, media arts, literary arts, traditional cultural expressions, multimedia arts and performing arts through partnerships with art organizations, production houses, independent artists/designers, and cultural groups.

B. Hours and models

TechPro Track	Academic Track
• Mandatory intensive <u>Work Immersion</u> of 320 hours. • Ensures hands-on skill mastery needed for the job.	• Learners may choose one modality: • <u>Field Exposure</u>: 80 hours • <u>Arts Apprenticeship</u>: 80-160 hours for creative mentorship • <u>Work Immersion</u>: 320 hours based

	on completed prerequisite electives
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Models for Work Immersion

I. One-Term Model

The One (1) Term Model is a delivery scheme where learners shall complete the immersion hours within a single term—in prescribed days (54, 55 and 61 days).

Option	TERM 1	TERM 2	TERM 3	Duration of Completion	Time Allotment
1				320 hours	6 hours per day 5 days per week 30 hours per week
2				320 hours	
3				320 hours	

Note: The time allotment is only suggested as a minimum and can be adjusted to a maximum of 8 hours per day.

II. Two-Term Model

Learners complete the 540 to 640 Work Immersion hours in 2 consecutive terms.

Option	TERM 1	TERM 2	TERM 3	Duration of Completion	Time Allotment
1	54 days	55 days		540 hours	5 hrs per day 5 days per week 25 hrs per week
2		55 days	61 days	640 hours	6 hrs per day 5 days per week 30 hrs per week

Note: The time allotment is only suggested as a minimum and can be adjusted to a maximum

Models of Field Exposure

Field Exposure may be scheduled in Term 1, Term 2, or Term 3, depending on the school's implementation plan and the availability of partner institutions or workplaces.

Option	TERM 1, 2, or 3	Duration of Completion	Time Allotment
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1		80 hours	• 20 hours Pre Field Exposure (Classroom Instruction) • 40 hours Field Exposure • 20 hours Post Field Exposure (Classroom Instruction)
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Models of Arts Apprenticeship

The Arts Apprenticeship is scheduled in this manner: Term 1 is allotted for prerequisite elective subjects or other elective subjects, Term 2: Conduct of Arts Apprenticeship and Term 3 is designated for Creative Production and Presentation.

Option	TERM 1	TERM 2	TERM 3	Duration of Completion	Time Allotment
1				160 hours	• 60 hours Pre Arts Apprenticeship (Classroom Instruction) • 40 hours Arts Apprenticeship Proper • 60 hours Post Arts Apprenticeship (Classroom Instruction)
2				160 hours	• 40 hours Pre Arts Apprenticeship (Classroom Instruction) • 80 hours Arts Apprenticeship Proper • 40 hours Post Arts Apprenticeship (Classroom Instruction)

C. School head role

1. Ensure the programs are aligned with existing education policies.
2. Appoint a Work Immersion Focal Person and a Work Immersion Teacher.
3. Strengthen Partnerships through a Memorandum of Agreement (MOA).
4. Serve as the official signatory for the school in all Memorandum of Agreement (MOA).
5. Review and approve plans, schedules, and deployment of learners.
6. Allocate funds for the Work Immersion, Field Exposure (Off-campus), and Arts Apprenticeship monitoring, subject to usual auditing protocols.
7. Monitor the preparation and implementation of the Work Immersion Program and ensure the timely submission of all reports.

D. Partnerships

Partner institutions (industries, companies, organizations) shall undergo site inspection and screening for suitability, safety, and security. All agreements require a **Memorandum of Agreement (MOA)** specifying roles, training plan, and immersion hours. Industry partners are encouraged to provide allowances (food, transport, medical) under DepEd's Adopt-A-School Program. **Partners shall also be oriented on child protection, data privacy, and gender sensitivity.**

Insurance coverage:

- Public schools – via MOOE funds
- Private schools – responsibility of the institution

Industry Requirements:

- Training plans shall align with elective subject competencies.
- Schools should collaborate with industry to integrate industry-specific skills into curricula.
- Industry partners shall:
 - Assign a focal person/mentor for learners
 - Provide facilities, tools, and equipment for real workplace experience

Incentives:

- Private sector partners may receive tax benefits, recognition, or co-branding opportunities (DO 40, s. 2015).
- Schools and SDOs should hold recognition programs for exemplary partners.

Guidelines for Finding and Selecting Industry Partners

1. Preparation & Mapping

- Conduct Industry Mapping - local scans, website reviews, physical mapping
- Utilize Local/National Data - LGU, DOLE PESO reports, development plans, national agency employment data
- Engage Industry Associations/Chambers - identify skills needs and labor market demands
- Curricular Alignment - ensure school offerings match industry demand

2. Selection Criteria for Partners

- Interest and Legality - genuine willingness to train learners, valid business registration

- Accessibility and Resources - accessible location, provision of tools, facilities, equipment, protective gear
- Safety and Supervision - compliance with workplace safety, qualified trainers

3. Guidelines for Engaging Industry Partners

- Intent & Initial Meeting - formal letter of intent and set meeting
- Define Arrangements - discuss policies, roles, and training plan
- Database Management - maintain an updated database
- Formalize via MOA - codified roles and responsibilities

E. Learner support while deployed

Kumustahan is a dedicated weekly mentoring and monitoring session designed to ensure the continuous well-being, professional growth, and technical progress of learners during their work immersion. These sessions aim to check-in with the learners, proactively address any concerns, and provide guidance and support as they navigate workplace challenges.

The **No Collection Policy** shall be strictly observed. **The learners' medical clearances, certificates, and insurance shall be charged to the school's local funds or MOOE**, subject to accounting and auditing rules. Private sector partners may, as part of their corporate social responsibility initiatives, co-fund aspects of the program, such as learner allowances and equipment provision to further support students during deployment.

F. Grading

Grading Component	Tracks	
	Academic	TechPro
	Field Exposure (Off-campus)/ Arts Apprenticeship	Work Immersion
Written Works	15 %	N/A
Portfolio	N/A	20 %
Performance	70 %	80 %
Assessment	15 %	N/A
Total	100 %	100 %